



Lesson 8: Balancing school and family

Describe daily study routines, discuss learning tools, and share advice for building good study habits while balancing school and family life.

 Objective: Talk about making time for both studying and family gatherings.

Warm-up

Family and study time

THINK AND SHARE

"What do you do when relatives visit while you're busy studying?"

START WITH:

- When I'm busy studying, I...
- I try to spend time with my relatives by...
- I usually tell my family that I need to...

Useful Language (Part 1)

busy 

DEF having a lot of things to do

EG I'm very busy with my homework today.

CHK Are you usually busy on Monday mornings or Sunday afternoons?

free time 

DEF time when you do not have to work or study

EG In my free time, I like to relax with my family.

CHK What do you prefer to do in your free time: watch TV or play sports?

Useful language (Part 2)

weekend

DEF Saturday and Sunday.

EG I try to finish my homework before the weekend starts.

CHK What do you usually do on the weekend: study or relax?

visit

DEF To go and see someone and spend time with them.

EG I want to visit my aunt, but I have a lot of schoolwork.

CHK Who do you visit more often: your friends or your family?

relatives

DEF Members of your family, such as aunts, uncles, and cousins.

EG My relatives live in another city, so we travel to see them.

CHK Where do most of your relatives live: in your city or far away?

Conversation Builder

Learn how to explain your schedule and plans.

- **...because I have to...** — To give a reason.
- **...so I can...** — To show a plan or goal.
- **...but I need to...** — To mention another important task.

MODEL DIALOG

Tutor: Hey, can you visit our relatives this weekend?

Student: I'd love to go, but I need to study. Actually, I'm pretty busy on Saturday because I have to finish my homework. Let's go on Sunday instead, so I can have some free time later.

Let's practice

TEACHER

"Imagine I'm your relative. I want to invite you over for a family visit this weekend, but you're really busy with school. Negotiate a time with me. 'Hi! Are you free to visit the relatives this Saturday morning?'"

STUDENT GUIDE

- 💡 I'm actually busy on Saturday because I have to ____.
- 💡 I can visit on Sunday instead. That way, I can ____.
- 💡 I'd really like to come, but I need to ____ first.

Real-world scenario

 **You: Student:** You're very busy with homework this weekend.

 **Tutor: Tutor:** You're a relative who is hosting a big family gathering.

⚡ THE PROBLEM

Your relative invites you to a family gathering this weekend, but you're busy with homework.

YOUR MISSION

-  Listen to your relative's invitation.
-  Explain that you're busy with your homework.
-  Suggest a different time to visit so you can finish studying.

▶ Hi there! We're having a big family gathering this Saturday at 1:00 PM. Would you like to come?

Wrap-Up

TODAY'S RECAP

- ✓ Vocabulary: busy, free time, weekend, visit, relatives
- ✓ Language chunks: ...because I have to... / ...so I can... / ...but I need to...
- ✓ Skill: Talk about making time for both studying and family gatherings.

FINAL TASK

Use one of today's chunks to answer this question: Can you visit your relatives this weekend?

 **Challenge:** This week, try using English to explain your study schedule and free time to a family member.